# Man Did Not Bring Knowledge of a God with Him from the Preexistence

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, p. 18
¶30. The object of the foregoing quotations [re: Cain & Abel] is to show to this class the way by which mankind were first made acquainted with the existence of God; that it was by a manifestation of God to man, and that God continued, after man's transgression [the Fall] to manifest himself to him and to his posterity, and, notwithstanding they were separated from his immediate presence [spiritual death] that they could not see his face, they continued to hear his voice,
¶31. Adam, thus being made acquainted with God, communicated the knowledge which he had unto his posterity; and it was through this means that the thought was first suggested to their minds that there was a God, which laid the foundation for the exercise of their faith, through which they could obtain a knowledge of his character and also of his glory.
¶32. Not only was there a manifestation made unto Adam of the existence of a God; but Moses informs us, as before quoted, that God condescended to talk with Cain after his great transgression in slaying his brother, and that Cain knew that it was the Lord that was talking with him, so that when he was driven out from the presence of his brethren, he carried with him the knowledge of the existence of a God; and, through this means, doubtless, his posterity became acquainted with the fact that such a Being existed.
¶33. From this we can see that the whole human family in the early age of their existence, in all their different branches, had this knowledge disseminated among them; so that the existence of God became an object of faith in the early age of the world. And the evidences which these men had of the existence of a God, was the testimony of their fathers in the first instance. [Facts from without their own being--obtained from the progenitors.]
¶34. The reason why we have been thus particular on this part of our subject, is that this class may see by what means it was that God became an object of faith among men after the fall; and what it was that stirred up the faith of multitudes to feel after him--to search after a knowledge of his character, perfections and attributes, until they became extensively acquainted with him, and not only commune with him and behold his glory, but be partakers of his power and stand in his presence.
¶35. Let this class mark particularly, that the testimony which these men had of the existence of a God, was the testimony of man [not an inborn, inherent thing]....
¶36. For instance, Abel, before he received the assurance from heaven that his offerings were acceptable unto God, had received the important information of his father that such a Being did exist ... and it has been handed down to the day and generation in which we live, as we shall show from the face of the sacred records.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Pg. 22
¶53. We have now traced the chronology of the world agreeable to the account given in our present Bible, from Adam to Abraham, and have clearly determined, beyond the power of controversy, that there was no difficulty in preserving the knowledge of God in the world from the creation of Adam, and the manifestation made to his immediate descendants [sic], as set forth in the former part of this lecture; so that the students in this class need not have any doubt resting on their minds on this subject, for they can easily see that it is impossible for it to be otherwise, but that the knowledge of the existence of a God must have continued from father to son, as a matter of tradition at least; for we cannot suppose that a knowledge of this important fact could have existed in the mind of any of the before-mentioned individuals, without their having made it known to their posterity.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Pg.20
¶44. From the foregoing it is easily to be seen, not only how the knowledge of God came into the world, but upon what principle it was preserved; that from the time it was first communicated, it was retained in the minds of righteous men, who taught not only their own posterity but the world; so that there was no need of a new revelation to man, after Adam's creation to Noah, to give them the first idea or notion of the existence of a God; and not only of a God, but the true and living God.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Q&A, Pg.25
What testimony had the immediate descendants of Adam, in proof of the existence of God? The testimony of their father. And after they were made acquainted with his existence, by the testimony of their father, they were dependent upon the exercise of their own faith, for a knowledge of his character, perfections, and attributes. Lecture 2: 23, 24, 25, 26.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Q&A, Pg.25
Had any other of the human family, besides Adam, a knowledge of the existence of God, in the first instance, by any other means than human testimony? They had not. For previous to the time that they could have power to obtain a manifestation for themselves, the all-important fact had been communicated to them by their common father; and so from father to child the knowledge was communicated as extensively as the knowledge of his existence was known; for it was by this means, in the first instance, that men had a knowledge of his existence. Lecture 2: 35, 36.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Q&A, Pg.25

How do you know that the knowledge of the existence of God was communicated in this manner, throughout the different ages of the world? By the chronology obtained through the revelations of God.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Q&A, Pg.28

According to the foregoing account how was the knowledge of the existence of God first suggested to the minds of men? By the manifestation made to our father Adam, when he was in the presence of God, both before and while he was in Eden. Lecture 2:44.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Q&A, Pg.29

How was the knowledge of the existence of God disseminated among the inhabitants of the world? By tradition from father to son. Lecture 2:44.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 2, Q&A, Pg.32

Is the knowledge of the existence of God a matter of mere tradition, founded upon human testimony alone, until persons receive a manifestation of God to themselves? It is.

*Lectures on Faith*, Lecture 3, Pg.33

¶1. In the second lecture it was shewn [sic] how it was that the knowledge of the existence of God came into the world, and by what means the first thoughts were suggested to the minds of men that such a Being did actually exist; and that it was by reason of the knowledge of his existence that there was a foundation laid for the exercise of faith in him, as the only Being in whom faith could center for life and salvation; for faith could not center in a Being of whose existence we have no idea, because the idea of his existence in the first instance is essential to the exercise of faith in him. Romans 10:14: "How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? and how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? and how shall they hear without a preacher (or one sent to tell them)? So, then, faith comes by hearing the word of God." (New Translation).
¶2. Let us here observe, that three things are necessary in order that any rational and intelligent being may exercise faith in God unto life and salvation.
¶3. First, the idea that he actually exists.
¶4. Secondly, a *correct* idea of his character, perfections, and attributes [what He is *really* like].
¶5. Thirdly, an actual **knowledge** that the course of life which he is pursuing is according to his will....

**Marion G. Romney**, *Look to God and Live* (SLC: Deseret Book Company, 1973), pg.66. Through a long period of growth and development, each person's spirit came to know God and spiritual things, including the gospel, obedience to which is a prerequisite to attaining eternal life. Men, however, enter mortality spiritually blind. Never in this life do they recover memory of premortal spiritual things. What they here learn of them must be revealed anew.

**John Taylor**, *Gospel Kingdom,* pg. 91 (see *Ensign* Jan 1994, pg. 10-11). How did Adam get his information of the things of God? He got it through the gospel of Jesus Christ.... God came to him in the garden and talked with him ...; and he ws the first man upon this earth that had the gospel and the holy priesthood; and if he had it not, he could not have known anything about God or his revelations.